

Current Functionality Handbook

A practical guide to what the platform does today, who can use each capability, and how the major workflows operate.

Contents and scope

This handbook describes functionality implemented in the current SportsUniverse codebase. “Implemented” means the application workflow exists; external services still require valid production configuration and running infrastructure.

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Important: payment processing, AI visual review, email, push, live signalling, queues, Redis, PostgreSQL, media processing and object/local storage depend on their production services and environment values.

Platform overview and roles

SportsUniverse is a sports-first social, talent, opportunity and commercial platform. The Laravel backend serves the Inertia/Vue web application and versioned APIs used by web and mobile clients.

Supported account roles

- Athlete
- Fan
- Coach
- Referee
- Linesman
- Scout
- Agent
- Club
- Academy
- Business
- Sponsor
- Admin
- System admin
- Super admin

ROLE FAMILY	CURRENT USE
Athletes and sporting professionals	Public identity, sporting details, career history, achievements, statistics, uploads, live content, analytics and applications.
Fans	Interest-based feed, following, engagement, discovery, messaging and saved content.
Clubs, academies and scouts	Public club presence, opportunities, shortlists, comparisons, notes, invitations, staff and recruitment pipeline.
Businesses and sponsors	Sponsorship campaigns, promoted posts, targeting, PayFast checkout and campaign metrics.
Administrators	Filament administration, reports, content moderation, AI suggestions, appeals, settings and operational oversight.

Responsive delivery

The web interface is responsive for desktop and mobile browsers. Versioned APIs provide the same core data and business rules for a mobile client, including authentication, feeds, profiles, messaging, notifications and media.

Authentication and account security

Registration and onboarding

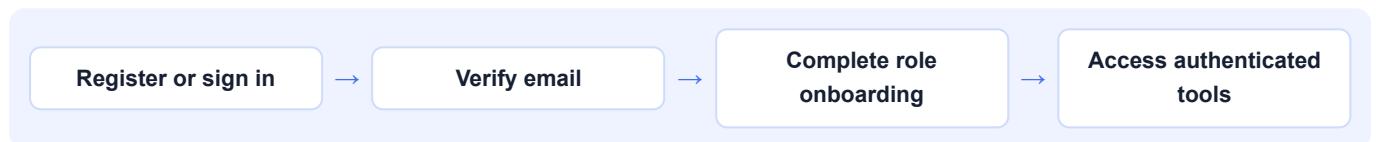
- Account registration with availability checks.
- Role selection and role-specific onboarding.
- Email verification and resend limits.
- Google, Facebook, Apple and Microsoft social login hooks.

Account recovery

- Forgot-password and signed reset flow.
- Session-expired screen.
- Web and API logout.
- Account-deletion request and cancellation APIs.

Session and device controls

Users can view recent sessions, identify the current session, revoke individual sessions, or sign out other devices. Login history is converted into readable device information.



Security protections currently present

- CSRF protection for state-changing web actions.
- Sanctum authentication for APIs.
- Role checks and model policies.
- Signed download and verification links.
- Rate limits for authentication, uploads, reports, messages and payment callbacks.
- Content Security Policy, secure focus states and restricted PayFast form destinations.

Profiles and sporting identity

Profiles combine general identity with role-specific sporting or organisational details. Public profiles use readable slugs such as `/@profile-name`.

CAPABILITY	HOW IT WORKS
General profile	Name, biography, location, profile image, cover image, visibility and completeness.
Athlete profile	Sport, position/taxonomy, sporting details and performance identity.
Professional profile	Professional role information for coaches, scouts, agents and officials.
Organisation profile	Club, academy, sponsor or business identity.
Career	Career history, achievements and season statistics can be added and removed.
Connections	Follower and following lists, counts, follow state and public profile discovery.

Users can save profiles and profile searches. Public athlete and club pages expose relevant posts, opportunities, career information and social actions while respecting privacy and blocking rules.

Feed and recommendation engine

For You

The For You feed selects published, public, approved sports content. It uses precomputed recommendation IDs when available and falls back to candidate retrieval and live ranking. Ranking considers interests, content metadata, engagement and freshness; diversification reduces repetition. Fan sport preferences, location, sport and position can narrow candidates.

Following

The Following feed contains normal posts from followed accounts and the viewer's own posts, ordered newest first. Stories are separated into the Stories row instead of being repeated as ordinary feed cards.

Scrolling and repetition

- Cursor pagination loads a small page at a time; it never retrieves the full database.
- Client-side duplicate keys prevent repeated items on the same scrolling session.
- Not-interested preferences remove a post, creator, sport or similar topic from future candidate sets.
- Impression, skip, replay, watch duration and completion signals improve subsequent recommendations.



Scale design: feed endpoints operate on indexed candidate subsets and cursor pages. The five-million-post dataset is intended for performance testing, not bulk delivery to the browser.

Posts, uploads and media

Supported publishing formats

- MP4, MOV and WebM video.
- JPG, PNG and WebP images.
- Up to ten pictures in a carousel, with a selectable cover.
- A combined video-and-picture carousel where supplied.

Creator workflow



EDITOR	CURRENT BEHAVIOR
Video trim	Select start point and a post length up to 60 seconds. Story videos are capped at 30 seconds.
Visual adjustments	Brightness, contrast, colour saturation, rotation, output width and compression quality.
Sports metadata	Sport, country, league, team, competition, content type, language, skills/topics and location.
Audience	Everyone, followers or only the creator for normal posts. Stories are follower-only unless promoted.
Draft resilience	Browser IndexedDB preserves unfinished media and metadata. Upload progress and reconnect guidance are shown.
Processing	Background workers trim/transcode video, create thumbnails and renditions, optimise media, moderate and publish when ready.

Creators can edit captions, hashtags, location, cover and visibility; publish drafts; list their posts, likes, favourites and reposts; or delete content they own.

Stories

- A Story can contain video or pictures.
- Video length cannot exceed 30 seconds; the limit is enforced in the editor, API and background finalisation.
- The lifetime begins when processing completes and the Story becomes published.
- Every Story expires exactly 24 hours after publication.
- Organic Stories are visible to the creator and followers only.

Placement

SURFACE	STORY BEHAVIOR
For You	Shows “Your Story” for creating or viewing the creator’s own active Story. Organic follower Stories do not appear as regular For You posts.
Following	Shows the dedicated horizontal Story circles for followed creators. Organic Stories are not duplicated in the normal Following post list.
Promoted placement	An approved, paid Story promotion can enter the normal For You feed for matching non-followers, but promotion never extends the 24-hour expiry.

Viewer

Tapping a circle opens a full-screen viewer. Images progress after six seconds; videos progress when playback ends. Viewers can move backward or forward, close the viewer, see remaining lifetime and use a sponsored call to action.

Engagement and social graph

Post engagement

- Like and unlike.
- Save and unsave.
- Comment and reply.
- Like comments.
- Share externally or repost internally.
- View counts using watch duration and completion.

Relationship actions

- Follow and unfollow profiles.
- Follow-back from notifications.
- Message mutual connections.
- Save profiles.
- Block and unblock users.
- Report posts, messages or profiles where supported.

Engagement mutations are designed as idempotent toggles where appropriate. Counts are returned after each action so web and mobile interfaces can update immediately.

Discovery and search

- Unified search across people and posts.
- Search by term, creator, hashtag, sport and location metadata.
- Saved searches and search-history clearing.
- Saved profiles.
- Women in Sports hub for profiles, stories and opportunities.
- Recommended and trending accounts based on recent views and weighted engagement.
- Feed links for sport, position and location.

Content intelligence

Posts store structured sport, country, league, team, competition, content type, language, skills, detected labels and topic weights. These features distinguish related areas—for example English football from South African football—rather than treating every football post as identical.

Messaging and notifications

Messaging

A first message to a non-mutual connection is sent as a request. Requests can be accepted or declined; accepted relationships open conversations. Conversations support read state, archive/unarchive, mute, typing state, reporting, editing/deleting owned messages and blocking.

Notifications

Notifications are grouped by date and category, include unread counts and allow individual deletion or “mark all read.” Preference controls cover messages, requests, opportunities, followers, engagement, moderation, profile views and email digest.

- Database notifications are the durable source.
- Realtime events update the open interface.
- Expo push jobs support mobile notifications when configured.
- Moderation notifications include AI flags, review results and appeal actions.

Live streaming

Authenticated users can create live rooms; viewers can discover active streams, join, exchange signalling data, send live messages and receive lifecycle updates.

CAPABILITY	CURRENT OPERATION
Host lifecycle	Create, heartbeat and explicitly end a stream.
Viewer lifecycle	Open a live room, join and refresh room state.
Realtime	WebRTC-style signalling and Reverb-backed realtime services.
Chat	Messages are posted to the live room and merged without duplicate IDs.
Capacity	Membership limits expose tiered live-audience capacity; actual large-event infrastructure must be sized accordingly.

Opportunities and applications

Opportunity owners

- Create, edit, publish, cancel and delete opportunities.
- Attach sport, role, location, deadline and requirements.
- View applicants and supporting material.
- Move applications through submitted, reviewing, shortlisted, accepted or rejected states.

Applicants

- Browse and view opportunities.
- Save or unsave opportunities.
- Apply with cover letter, résumé and requirement documents.
- Track status and reviewer notes.
- Withdraw an application.

Status history creates a visible application timeline and supports notifications when an organiser changes an application.

Club workspace

Eligible club, academy and scout users receive a recruitment workspace separate from the public club page.

Talent management

- Create shortlists.
- Add athletes.
- Write private notes.
- Compare athletes.
- Send invitations.

Team operations

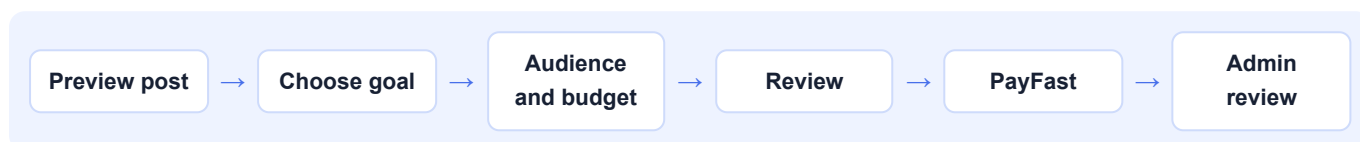
- Manage staff access.
- Update or remove staff.
- Review recruitment pipeline.
- Move applications between stages.
- Update club workspace information.

Advertising and sponsorship

Campaign types

TYPE	GOALS
Post or Story promotion	Views, followers, website visits or awareness.
Sponsorship campaign	Applications, website visits or awareness without requiring an existing post.

Creation flow



The post selector displays video or image previews before selection. Targeting supports sport, gender, province and age range. Daily budget and duration generate estimated reach and a total.

Delivery controls

- Only active, paid and approved campaigns are eligible.
- Campaign dates, remaining budget, daily pacing and per-viewer frequency caps are enforced.
- Blocked users and not-interested preferences remain excluded.
- Audience metadata is matched before insertion.
- A promoted post is not duplicated on the same page.
- Impressions, clicks, video views, profile visits, follows, reach and spend are tracked by delivery.

PayFast

Campaign and membership checkouts generate signed browser POST forms. Return, cancellation and ITN routes are separate. ITNs validate source, signature, merchant, amount and PayFast server confirmation before changing payment or campaign state.

Sandbox rule: PayFast default sandbox Merchant ID `10000100` and Key `46f0cd694581a` must use an empty passphrase. Live mode requires the exact live account credentials and matching passphrase.

Membership packages

PLAN	CURRENT POSITIONING	INDICATIVE LIMITS
Free	Complete core sporting profile and community experience.	1,000 live viewers, 5 GB storage, one workspace seat, 30-day analytics.
Pro	Professional growth for athletes, coaches, scouts and creators.	10,000 live viewers, 50 GB, three seats, 365-day analytics and discovery tools.
Elite	Club, academy, agency, sponsor and event operations.	100,000 live viewers, 500 GB, 15 seats, extended analytics and branded operations.

- Monthly or annual billing; annual pricing represents the configured annual total.
- Paid checkout uses PayFast.
- Free downgrade is scheduled at the end of the current paid period.
- Profile, posts, followers and opportunities remain intact when plans change.
- Entitlements are resolved from the current subscription and plan limits.

Production requirement: the Free, Pro and Elite cards require `SubscriptionPlanSeeder` . The deployment workflow now includes this seed step; an empty-state warning appears if records are missing.

Analytics

Creator analytics

- Seven, 30 and 90-day periods.
- Video and profile views.
- Likes, comments, shares and saves.
- Engagement rate and interaction totals.
- Follower and lifetime totals.
- Content and audience performance breakdowns where data exists.

Campaign analytics

Campaign dashboards expose budget, status, impressions, unique reach, clicks, click rate, video views, profile visits, follows and spend.

Admin analytics

Administrative APIs provide platform-level analytics. Subscription analytics is restricted to system-admin and super-admin roles.

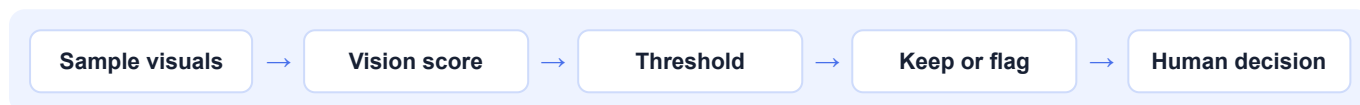
Moderation and appeals

General moderation

- Users can report supported content with a reason and details.
- Admins review open reports, pending/flagged media and flagged posts.
- Actions can approve, flag, hide, reject or restore according to the content type.
- Every administrator decision is written to a moderation audit log.

Sports-relevance vision engine

A separate Python service samples eight frames across a video or reviews up to ten post images. A CLIP vision model compares the visuals with sports and non-sports concepts, then returns a sports-relevance score and explanation.



- Low-scoring published content becomes `flagged` and leaves public feeds.
- The recommendation is “review for removal”; the engine never permanently deletes content.
- Admins see all AI suggestions, score, reason, creator and media.

Creator appeal

The creator receives a moderation notification and can send a message explaining why the content is sports-related. Duplicate pending appeals are blocked. Admins see the appeal alongside the AI evidence and can restore the post or uphold removal. The result is sent back to the creator and audited.

Administrative control

Active admin, system-admin and super-admin accounts can enter the Filament panel. Higher-risk configuration is further restricted to system-admin or super-admin.

AREA	CONTROLS
Users and organisations	Status, verification and operational review.
Media and videos	Metadata, moderation status, AI score/reason, approve, publish, hide or reject.
Reports and appeals	Triage, assign, resolve, dismiss, restore or uphold removal.
Campaigns	Payment state, pending review, activate/reject and campaign settings.
Feed	Ranking behavior, page size, fan sports and boost settings.
Membership	Subscription analytics for system ownership roles.

A repeatable production-access seeder can create separate super-admin, athlete and sponsor accounts with one-time generated passwords without committing secrets.

Mobile and installation

- Responsive layouts, bottom navigation behavior and touch-friendly actions.
- Camera capture and mobile media selection from upload.
- Versioned Sanctum API for mobile authentication and platform features.
- Mobile configuration endpoint with supported/current version details.
- iOS Universal Links and Android App Links association files.
- Mobile download page with iOS, Android and direct-download configuration.
- Expo push-token subscription endpoints and queued push delivery.
- Service-worker hooks for offline upload-draft recovery and resume messaging.

Shared rules: feed visibility, Story expiry, moderation, campaign eligibility and access policies are enforced server-side, so mobile and web clients receive the same business behavior.

Data scale and production operations

Large feed dataset

The mass-feed generator can create up to five million deterministic PostgreSQL posts across configured sports, reusing licensed sports images and sampled source videos. It inserts in batches, creates topic records and resumes based on deterministic IDs.

- Command: `php artisan feed:seed-mass-posts --count=5000000 --batch=100000` .
- The operation is idempotent for the deterministic mass-feed ID range.
- The dedicated automatic production workflow was intentionally removed; production import can be handled through DBever as requested.

Runtime architecture

COMPONENT	PURPOSE
PostgreSQL	Primary relational store, feed indexes, cursor queries and large dataset operations.
Redis	Cache, queues, counters and realtime support when enabled.
Queue workers	Media processing, analysis, notifications and background jobs.
FFmpeg/FFprobe	Video trim, probing, thumbnail creation and renditions.
Reverb	Realtime application events and live features.
OpenSearch	Optional scalable discovery/search integration.
Nginx and PHP-FPM	Production web delivery and PHP execution.

Current operational dependencies

FEATURE	REQUIRED PRODUCTION SETUP
PayFast	Correct sandbox or live Merchant ID, Key and matching passphrase; HTTPS public callback URLs; refreshed Laravel config cache.
Membership cards	Subscription-plan migration and <code>SubscriptionPlanSeeder</code> .
Sports visual moderation	Python moderation container, reachable analysis URL, matching service token and queue worker.
Uploads	Writable storage, storage link, FFmpeg/FFprobe, queue worker and suitable PHP/Nginx limits.
Email	Working SMTP credentials and verified sender.
Push	Expo/mobile configuration and registered device tokens.
Realtime/live	Reverb service, secure public host and signalling-compatible network setup.
Large feed	PostgreSQL capacity, licensed source media, monitoring and deliberate DBEaver or CLI import.

Suggested production verification

1. Run migrations and required deterministic seeders.
2. Clear and rebuild configuration caches.
3. Confirm queue and Reverb services are active.
4. Verify ``/up``, ``/feed``, ``/following``, ``/membership`` and ``/admin`` for the correct roles.
5. Test a sandbox PayFast transaction and confirm the ITN updates payment state.
6. Upload one image, normal video and Story; confirm processing and expiry fields.
7. Submit one AI moderation appeal and complete the admin decision.

This handbook reflects the repository state on 21 July 2026. It is a functional guide, not a promise that every external provider is enabled in every environment.

Management workspaces and location services

The following capabilities extend the administration and data-entry workflows described earlier in this handbook. They are implemented in the current local codebase and must be deployed before they become available in production.

Management workspaces

ROUTE	CURRENT CAPABILITY
<code>/management/comments</code>	Moderation queue for reports, media, videos and appeals. Report cards include the reported text, creator, media preview and a link to the original content where available. Administrators can approve, remove, dismiss, restore or uphold content according to its type.
<code>/management/campaigns</code>	Live campaign dashboard using campaign, payment, budget, schedule, impression and click data. Administrators can search, filter, inspect payment state, add review notes and approve or reject campaigns. Activation is blocked until a paid payment record exists.
<code>/management/taxonomy</code>	Database-backed sports and playing-position management. Administrators can add, edit, activate or hide terms. Hiding preserves references on existing profiles and content while removing the term from new selection lists.
<code>/management/settings</code>	Real feed-ranking and advertising controls. Feed changes clear prepared recommendation rows so they rebuild with the new strategy. Environment-controlled values such as PayFast mode, debug, mail, cache and queue drivers are displayed read-only.
<code>/admin</code>	The Filament administration panel remains available for resource-level administration. Its dashboard uses a light theme and avoids loading a redundant welcome widget.

Sports taxonomy catalogue

Sports and positions are stored in the `sports` and `positions` tables; they are not embedded in the management interface. A recommended South African catalogue can be imported from the taxonomy screen. The import adds missing sports and positions without overwriting administrator edits. The catalogue includes football, rugby, cricket, netball, athletics, basketball, hockey, swimming, tennis, golf, boxing, cycling, rowing, surfing, gymnastics, volleyball, combat sports, motorsport and para sport.

Performance rule: taxonomy management loads only taxonomy records. Counts over production-sized video and analytics tables are intentionally excluded from the initial request so millions of posts cannot block the screen. A failed request stops after a bounded wait and presents a visible retry action instead of an endless spinner.

Google Places location entry

A reusable Google Places autocomplete control is used for profile locations, opportunity locations and post/upload locations. Selecting a Google result supplies a formatted name and structured country, province, city and locality values. Post uploads also retain latitude and longitude. Manual entry remains available when Google cannot load or no browser key is configured.

CONFIGURATION	REQUIREMENT
Google Cloud APIs	Enable Maps JavaScript API and Places API for the selected Google Cloud project.

Browser environment	Set <code>VITE_GOOGLE_MAPS_API_KEY</code> , then rebuild or restart the Vite frontend.
Key security	Restrict the key by authorised website referrers for localhost, test and production domains, and restrict API access to the APIs actually used.
Data requested	Formatted address, display name, coordinates and address components required for structured platform fields.
Fallback	The interface remains usable with manual location entry if the provider is unavailable.

Local development and verification

- The application dependencies require PHP 8.3 or newer. The bundled XAMPP PHP 8.0 executable cannot boot the current Laravel application.
- Use the local PostgreSQL database and database-backed session, cache and queue configuration unless local Redis and its PHP extension are intentionally installed.
- After adding or changing a `VITE_*` variable, restart the frontend development process.
- After changing Laravel environment configuration, clear and rebuild the configuration cache using the same PHP runtime that serves the application.
- PayFast sandbox and live credentials must never be mixed. Merchant ID, merchant key and passphrase must match the selected PayFast account and generated signature exactly.
- A completed browser return is not authoritative payment confirmation. The PayFast ITN/callback must validate and update the payment record before campaign or membership state changes.

Deployment status: the management, taxonomy, settings and Google Places changes documented in this update are currently local and intentionally have not been committed, pushed or deployed to production.